

Retention Playbook P1 - Auto-Renew Re-enablement

When this applies

This playbook targets subscribers whose auto-renew flag is off (`is_auto_renew = 0`). This is the single strongest churn driver in the scoring model: a subscriber who has turned off auto-renewal will lapse silently at the end of their current billing cycle unless they take a manual action to re-subscribe. Unlike engagement-based risk, this is a structural risk - the subscriber may still be actively listening, but the account is on a countdown to non-renewal regardless of usage.

Auto-renew-off subscribers should be treated as the highest-priority contact segment. In the current scoring population, this single flag accounts for the majority of the SHAP-attributed churn risk across the paying base.

Root causes to distinguish before choosing an offer

Auto-renew can be off for several different reasons, and the right playbook branch depends on which one applies: (1) Accidental or forgotten opt-out - the subscriber disabled auto-renew during a promo period or after a billing dispute and never turned it back on. (2) Active price sensitivity - the subscriber disabled auto-renew specifically to avoid being charged full price when a discount period ends (see Playbook P3 for the price-sensitive branch; these two often co-occur and should be handled together). (3) Deliberate churn intent - the subscriber has already decided to leave and turned off auto-renew as the first step; engagement signals (`recency`, `activity_trend`) help distinguish this group from the merely-forgetful group.

Recommended interventions

Tier 1 (7 days before cycle end): send a renewal reminder that surfaces the exact renewal date and price, with a single-tap re-enable action. No discount is offered at this stage - most reactivations at this tier are the "forgotten opt-out" group and do not require a financial incentive.

Tier 2 (2 days before cycle end, no action taken): escalate to a retention offer. If `actual_amount_paid` is already well below `plan_list_price` (an active discount), do not add a further discount - instead offer a plan-length concession (e.g. switch to a shorter `payment_plan_days` cycle at the same rate) to reduce the size of the commitment the subscriber is being asked to re-enable.

Tier 3 (cycle has lapsed): treat as a win-back case, not a renewal case - hand off to Playbook P4 (dormant win-back) rather than continuing to push auto-renew messaging, since the account is now inactive rather than merely non-renewing.

What NOT to do

Do not lead with a discount for subscribers who re-enabled auto-renew on their own in the last 90 days - this trains the base to churn strategically in order to farm offers. Do not conflate this playbook with dormant win-back (P4): a subscriber with auto-renew off but high recent activity is a payment-mechanics problem, not an engagement problem, and a discovery-focused campaign will not move them.